

THE CRIMSON MONETIZATION:

A RIGOROUS INVESTIGATION INTO THE CORPORATE CAPTURE OF SAINT NICHOLAS

OR:
HOW I LEARNED TO STOP WORRYING AND LOVE THE HOLIDAYS ARE COMING



SUBJECT:

Critical Socio-Commercial Analysis / Festive Satire



DATE:

December 2025



STATUS:

Seasonally Adjusted



SANTA CLAUS
CHIEF BRAND OFFICER
(FORMERLY SAINT)

CONFIDENTIAL

NORTH POLE HOLDINGS GROUP™

DO NOT BELIEVE. CONSUME.

COMPLIANCE
MAKES THE MAGIC WORK

ABSTRACT



BEFORE:

Green, Sacred,
Unprofitable.

This paper presents a formal investigation into the most successful rebranding campaign in human history: the systematic transformation of Saint Nicholas from a green-robed bishop into a red-suited corporate mascot. We argue that the modern image of "Santa Claus" is not a natural evolution of folklore, but a calculated act of *Chromatic Colonization* designed to maximize fourth-quarter beverage sales.



AFTER:

Red, Refreshing,
Immensely Profitable.

Thirst asks
nothing more
...than ice cold
refreshment



DATA ELF, LEVEL 3
DOCUMENTS EVERYTHING.
BELIEVES IN NOTHING.

Through rigorous analysis of historical iconography, we demonstrate that Santa's current appearance is a direct product of 1930s Coca-Cola advertising campaigns. The jolly red figure we know today is not authentic tradition—it is *Marketable Tradition™*, a corporate fiction so successful it has retroactively edited our collective cultural memory.

However, in keeping with established methodology, we will conclude by systematically dismantling our own thesis and confessing that the "Holidays Are Coming" advert is, in fact, the pinnacle of human artistic achievement.



BEAUTY. NOSTALGIA. LIGHTS.
Art. Commerce. Unity.
All in Perfect Harmony.



FESTIVE TRUTH. COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCES.
AN ONGOING INVESTIGATION.



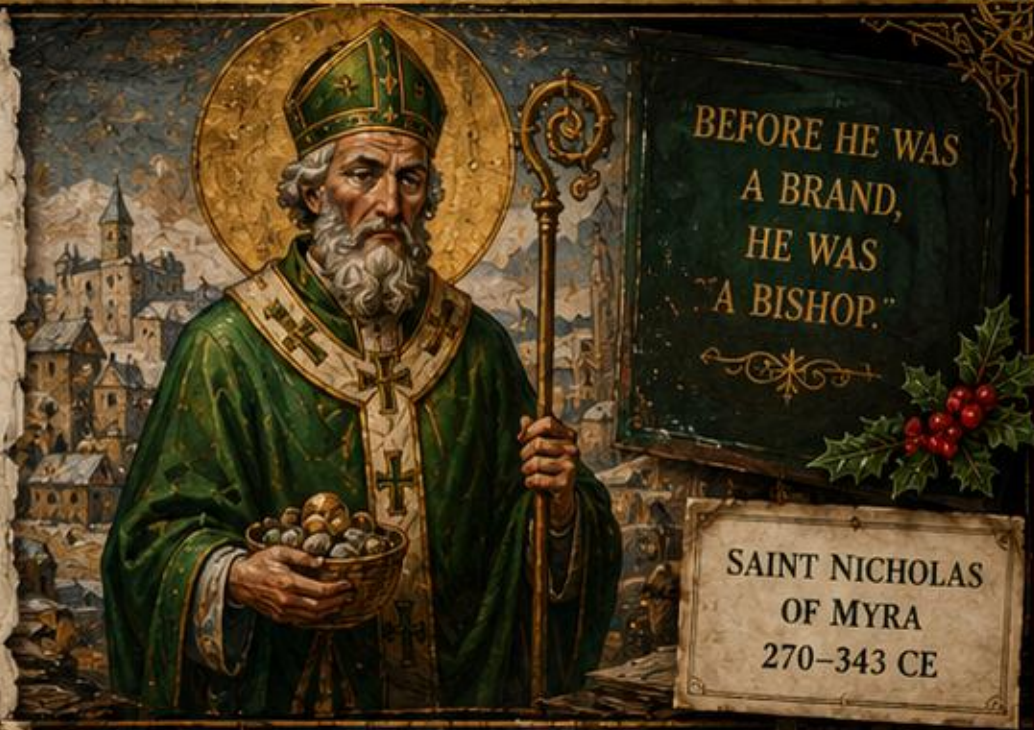
PAGE 1 OF 9

I. THE ORIGINAL GREEN: HISTORICAL EVIDENCE OF PRE-COMMERCIAL SAINT NICHOLAS

1.1 THE BISHOP'S VESTMENTS

Historical records consistently depict Saint Nicholas of Myra (270-343 CE) in traditional bishop's robes, which in the Byzantine tradition were predominantly green and gold. The association with red vestments did not emerge until significantly later and had no connection to his charitable activities.

*12th Century Manuscript
Saint Nicholas in Green
Bishop's Robes*



KEY EVIDENCE:



Medieval manuscripts (12th-15th century) show variations including **green, blue, and brown robes**



Dutch Sinterklaas tradition maintained **red bishop's robes**, but with entirely different iconography (tall, thin, formal)



Victorian Christmas cards (pre-1930s) depict Father Christmas in **green, white, or brown fur-trimmed robes**



Thomas Nast illustrations (1860s-1880s) show a small, elf-like figure in **various colors**



The modern, standardized red suit is a **20th-century** invention.

1.2 THE COLOR OF GENEROSITY

Why green? The color symbolized:



Evergreen life (winter vitality, eternal hope)



Natural abundance (holly, ivy, mistletoe)



The forest spirit (pre-Christian winter celebrations)



Green was the color of non-commercial generosity—the spontaneous, unmonetized gift of nature. It represented a giving that existed outside market logic, a generosity that could not be bottled, branded, or sold.

THIS WAS DEEPLY PROBLEMATIC FOR
EMERGING CONSUMER CAPITALISM.



FESTIVE TRUTH. COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCES.
AN ONGOING INVESTIGATION.



PAGE 2 OF 9

II. THE COCA-COLA CONSPIRACY:

1931 AND THE BIRTH OF RED SANTA

2.1 THE CAMPAIGN

In 1931, Coca-Cola commissioned illustrator Haddon Sundblom to create a series of Santa Claus advertisements. The brief was explicit: create a warm, friendly, wholly human Santa who embodied the spirit of Coca-Cola.

SUNDBLOM'S SANTA WAS:



JOLLY AND PLUMP
(suggesting abundant consumption)



DRESSED IN BRIGHT RED
(matching Coca-Cola's brand colors)



HOLDING A COKE
(the not-so-subtle product placement)



UNIVERSALLY APPEALING
(designed for mass-market reproduction)

The campaign ran for over 30 years and became the most widely distributed image of Santa Claus in history.

2.2 THE CHROMATIC COUP

This was not merely advertising—it was cultural engineering. By saturating the market with a single, consistent image, Coca-Cola achieved something remarkable: they retroactively rewrote folklore.

WITHIN TWO GENERATIONS:

- ✓ GREEN SANTA WAS FORGOTTEN
- ✓ RED BECAME "TRADITIONAL"
- ✓ COCA-COLA'S SANTA BECAME THE SANTA
- ✓ ALTERNATIVE DEPICTIONS WERE VIEWED AS INAUTHENTIC

The company had successfully executed a *Chromatic Colonization*: the corporate capture of a pre-commercial symbol system.

They didn't just sell a product; they sold a reality.



FESTIVE TRUTH. COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCES.
AN ONGOING INVESTIGATION.



2.3

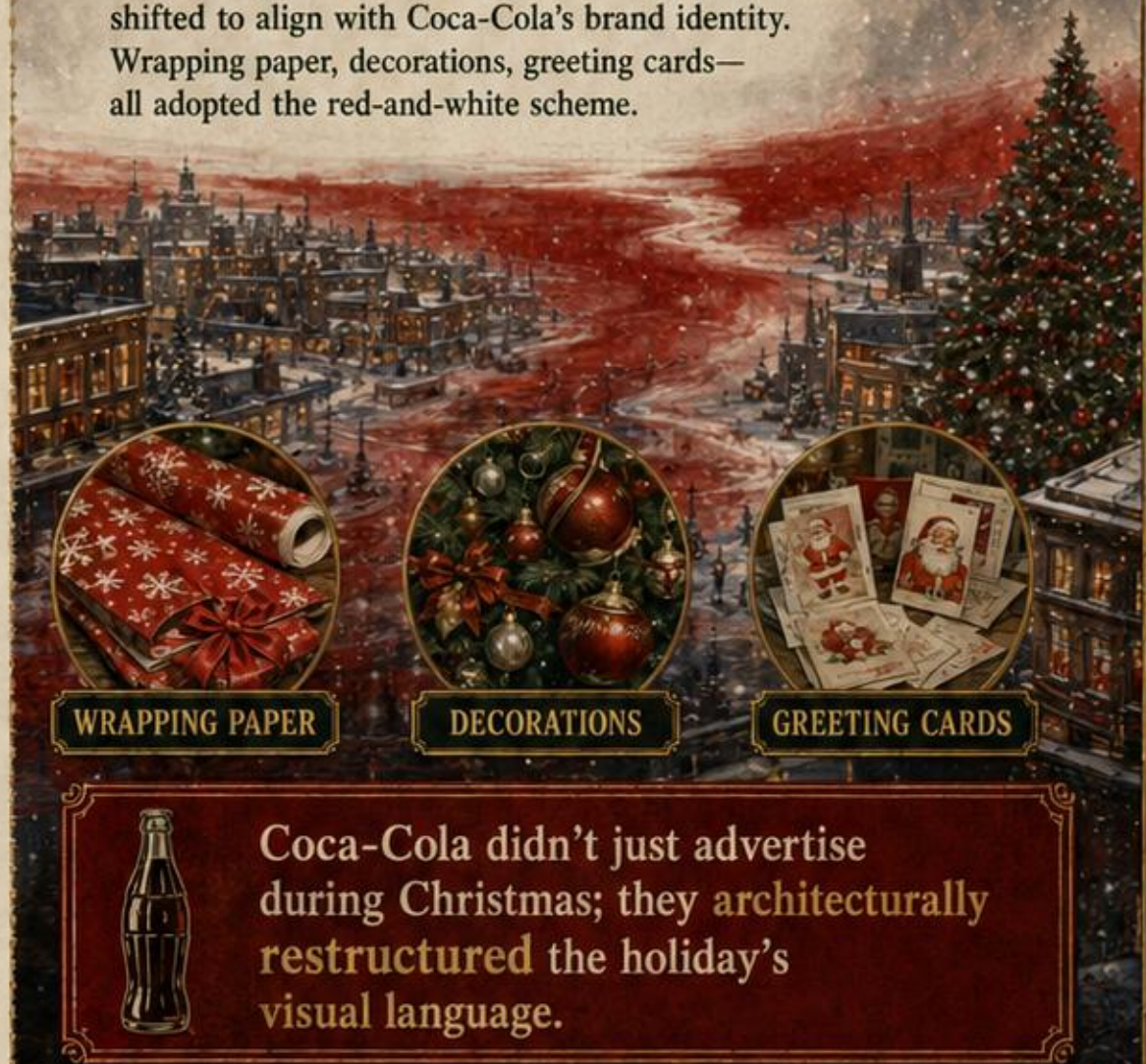
THE MONETIZATION FORMULA

The genius of the campaign was its recursive self-justification:



The final step is crucial: once Santa became red, **all Christmas became red.**

The color palette of the entire holiday season shifted to align with Coca-Cola's brand identity. Wrapping paper, decorations, greeting cards—all adopted the red-and-white scheme.



III. THE INSTITUTIONAL REBOUND: WE ALWAYS KNEW HE WAS RED

HISTORY IS
WHAT WE AGREE
IT WAS

3.1 THE HISTORICAL AMNESIA

Ask anyone today:

"What color is Santa's suit?"

The answer is instant, universal, and unquestioned: **Red.**

Ask why it's red:

"Because... it's traditional?"

This is the ultimate institutional victory. The corporate origin has been so thoroughly erased that even mentioning it provokes cognitive dissonance. People respond as if you've suggested the sky is green.



This is **Implanted Nostalgia**—the false memory of authenticity in something that was, from the beginning, a commercial construct.



FESTIVE TRUTH. COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCES.
AN ONGOING INVESTIGATION.



PAGE 4 OF 9

GREEN: GIFT ECONOMY

RED: MARKET ECONOMY

SHARED JOY
NOT OWNERSHIP

COMMUNITY
NOT CONSUMPTION

MEANING
NOT MERCHANDISE

SEASONAL CYCLES,
NOT SALES CYCLES

NATURAL. SEASONAL. GENEROUS.
THE SPIRIT OF GIVING.

THE MODERN
CHRISTMAS:
A CHROMATIC SHIFT.
A CULTURAL SHIFT.

OPTIMIZE.
MONETIZE.
MAXIMIZE.

THE SPIRIT OF GETTING
EVERYONE TO BUY.

Q4 PERFORMANCE
UNITS SHIPPED ↑
REVENUE GROWTH ↑
MARKET SHARE ↑
BRAND ENGAGEMENT ↑
CONSUMER REACH ↑
DELIVERING
SHAREHOLDER JOY
SINCE 1931

3.2 THE REBRANDING OF GENEROSITY

The chromatic shift from green to red represents a deeper transformation: the commodification of giving.



GREEN SANTA represents
natural, seasonal generosity—
a gift economy



RED SANTA represents
consumer abundance—
a market economy

The modern Christmas is no longer about the quiet generosity of winter; it's about optimized consumption logistics. Santa doesn't embody the spirit of giving; he embodies the spirit of getting everyone to buy stuff in Q4.

AND YET, WE DEFEND THIS
PASSIONATELY AS "TRADITION."

IV. THE FINAL TWIST: THE RECURSIVE CONFESSION

4.1 THE INESCAPABLE INSIDE

At this point, having thoroughly dismantled the commercial mythology of Christmas, having exposed the red suit as corporate propaganda, having revealed Santa as a brand ambassador—we must now turn the blade inward.

BECAUSE HERE IS THE TRUTH I CANNOT ESCAPE:

THE "HOLIDAYS ARE COMING" COCA-COLA ADVERT
IS THE BEST THING ABOUT CHRISTMAS.

Every year, without fail, the moment I see those illuminated trucks rolling through the snow, hear that haunting choir, and watch that impossibly perfect Santa waving from his Coca-Cola sleigh, I feel it—the Christmas feeling.



NOT BECAUSE IT'S AUTHENTIC.
NOT BECAUSE IT'S TRADITIONAL.
BUT BECAUSE IT'S PERFECTLY EXECUTED
EMOTIONAL MANIPULATION, AND I LOVE IT.



FESTIVE TRUTH. COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCES.
AN ONGOING INVESTIGATION.

4.2 The Guilty Pleasure Paradox

I am fully aware that:



The advert is a commercial for sugar water



The red suit is a corporate invention



The "magic" is manufactured nostalgia



The whole thing is designed to make me buy beverages

And yet, when those trucks appear on screen and the music swells, I am transported. I am eight years old again. Christmas is real. The world is good.

This is the ultimate institutional triumph: they have successfully implanted a Pavlovian response that overrides my critical faculties. I have been emotionally hacked, and I'm grateful for it.



4.3 The Capitulation

Therefore, in the spirit of rigorous self-critique, I must confess:

Coca-Cola was right to make Santa red.

Not because red is "traditional."

Not because it's historically accurate.

But because they created something genuinely beautiful in service of selling carbonated beverages, and that's oddly... magnificent?

The chromatic colonization was worth it. Green Santa is boring. Red Santa is iconic.

I have become the Black Knight defending the very system I set out to critique. My argument has been dismembered, yet here I stand, insisting "'Tis but a flesh wound! The holidays are coming, and I'm delighted about it!"



FESTIVE TRUTH. COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCES.
AN ONGOING INVESTIGATION.



PAGE 6 OF 9

V. SEASONAL INTERLUDE: A MESSAGE TO THE REPOSITORY

5.1 THE PHYSICS HIATUS

To all who have followed this research program on GitHub—thank you.

You've engaged with:

- * Galactic rotation curves
- * Cosmological curvature gradients
- * Curvature saturation models
- * Universal gravitational scaling
- * MTS field theory
- * Assorted satirical deconstructions of institutional logic

It's been a year of equations, datasets, and recursive paradoxes.

But now, as December unfolds and the illuminated trucks roll through the night, there will be no new physics papers for a few weeks.

Not because the research has stopped. Not because the patterns have ceased. But because even theoretical physicists need to eat too much food, argue with relatives, and watch adverts that shouldn't work but absolutely do.

5.2 THE HOLIDAY PRIVILEGE

Physics will wait. The universe has been expanding for 13.8 billion years; it can manage another fortnight without my GitHub commits.

Instead, I'll be doing what every human should do in late December:

-  Pretending to enjoy social gatherings
-  Eating experimentally large quantities of food
-  Watching the "Holidays Are Coming" advert on repeat
-  Feeling vaguely guilty about all of the above
-  Resolving to be more productive in January (a resolution that will last approximately 11 days)

This is the ritual. This is the tradition. And yes, it's all built on commercial foundations, but the foundations don't determine the meaning.

PHYSICS WILL WAIT.
COOKIES WILL NOT.

REPOSITORY NOTE

No new physics papers for a few weeks.

- * Back soon. Smarter. Fatter. Possibly wiser.

Happy Holidays.

DATASET GRAVEYARD

v42, FINAL_FINAL
(THIS TIME)

CURVATURE MODELS
DO NOT DELETE

TODO (JAN):
Resume world domination through elegant mathematics.

RESEARCH STATUS

- ☒ Running on caffeine
- ☐ Surviving on snacks
- ☐ Questioning reality
- ☒ All of the above

Reminder:
The universe doesn't check your commit history.

EXPERIMENTALLY
LARGE
QUANTITIES
OF FOOD

HAPPY
HOLIDAYS,
HUMANS

THANK YOU
FOR READING.
SEE YOU IN
JANUARY.

Holidays
Are Coming



FESTIVE TRUTH. COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCES.
AN ONGOING INVESTIGATION.



PAGE 7 OF 9

5.3 THE GENUINE BIT

So here's the real conclusion, the one that survives even recursive satire:

Thank you for reading this work.

Thank you for engaging with the absurdity, the rigor, the equations, the jokes, and the occasionally unhinged explorations of why institutions persist in defending their own obsolescence.

Thank you for tolerating papers that critique themselves, for following arguments that prove their own irrelevance, and for recognizing that sometimes the best way to understand a system is to laugh at it while standing inside it.



I HOPE YOUR DECEMBER IS FILLED WITH:



Holidays Are Coming adverts
(the pinnacle of human achievement)



Too much food
(empirically necessary)



Questionable family dynamics
(statistically unavoidable)



A brief, merciful pause from whatever institutional nonsense you're embedded in



AND I HOPE, WHEN JANUARY ARRIVES AND WE ALL RETURN TO OUR RESPECTIVE DELUSIONS OF PRODUCTIVITY, YOU'LL COME BACK TO THE REPOSITORY READY FOR ANOTHER YEAR OF:

- ☒ Empirical patterns
- ☒ Computational models
- ☒ Geometric hypotheses
- ☒ And the occasional dismantling of things that should have stopped existing years ago



VI. CONCLUSION:

MERRY CHROMATIC COLONIZATION TO ALL

The Santa we know is a corporate invention. Christmas is a commercial construct. The "Holidays Are Coming" advert is emotional manipulation designed to sell sugar water.

And it's all absolutely wonderful.

Because here's the final truth: humans need rituals. We need shared stories, familiar music, and yes, even commercialized nostalgia. We need something that says, "The year is ending, the world is cold, but for a few weeks we can pretend everything is warm and lit and okay."

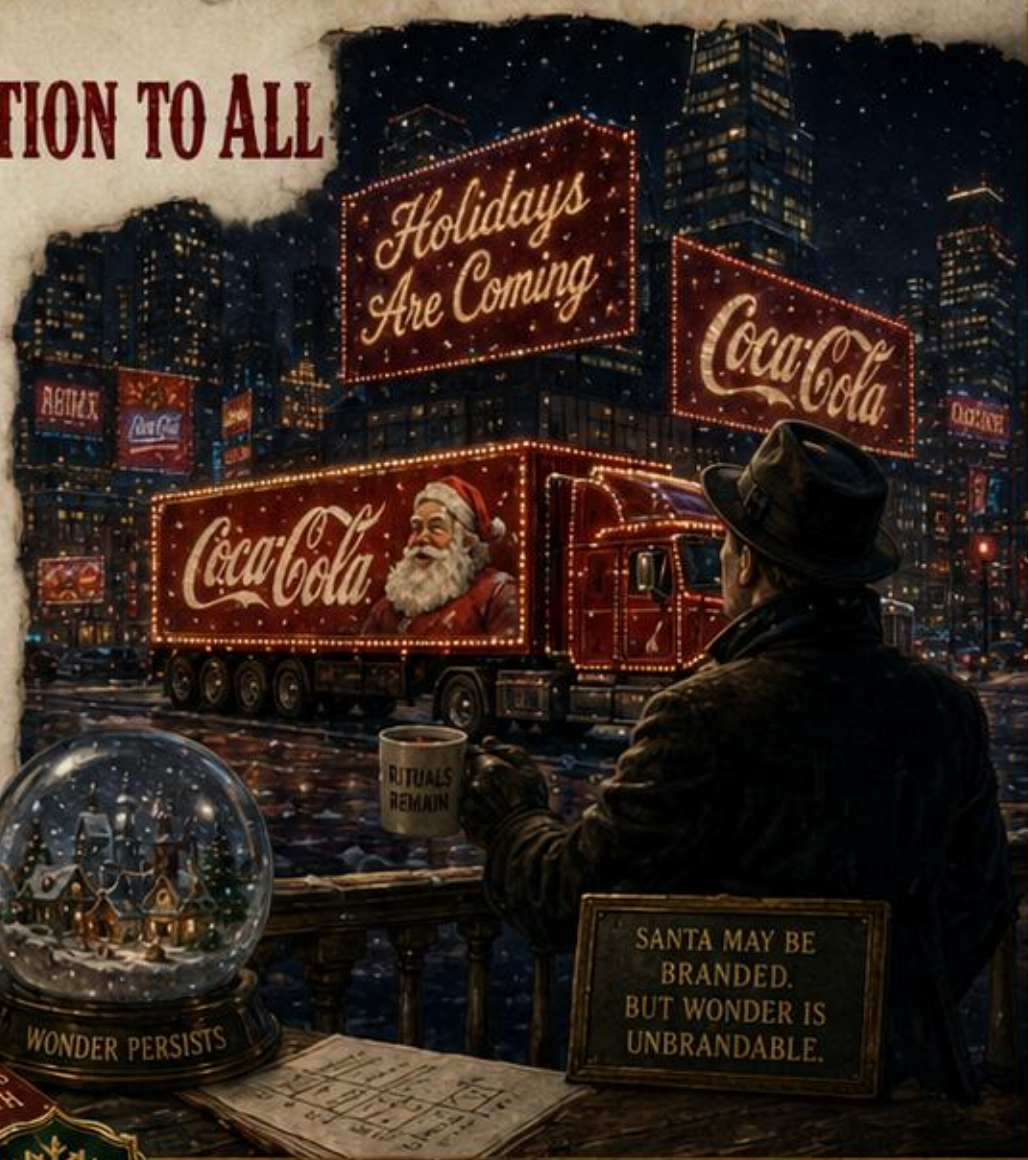
Does it matter that Coca-Cola built the iconography? Does it matter that the red suit is a branding exercise? Does it matter that the whole system is designed to extract value from our need for comfort?

No. Because the experience is real, even if the tradition is manufactured.

Santa may not be authentic, but the feeling he represents—the hope that generosity exists, that someone is watching, that the good will be rewarded—that feeling is as old as humanity itself.

Coca-Cola didn't create that. They just bottled it.

And honestly? They did a pretty good job.



NOSTALGIA:
A SOFT
INSTITUTIONAL
DEPENDENCY

RITUALS & REASSURANCE
COMMODITY & COMFORT
MYTH, MEANING, & MEMORY

THE FEELING IS
THE TRUTH

WONDER PERSISTS

SANTA MAY BE
BRANDED.
BUT WONDER IS
UNBRANDABLE.



FESTIVE TRUTH. COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCES.
AN ONGOING INVESTIGATION.



SEASONAL SIGN-OFF

To everyone who has engaged with
this research program in 2025:

MERRY CHRISTMAS.

HAPPY HOLIDAYS.

JOYFUL CHROMATIC COLONIZATION.

May your December be full of
trucks, lights, and beverages.

The physics will return in January.

The satire will continue indefinitely.

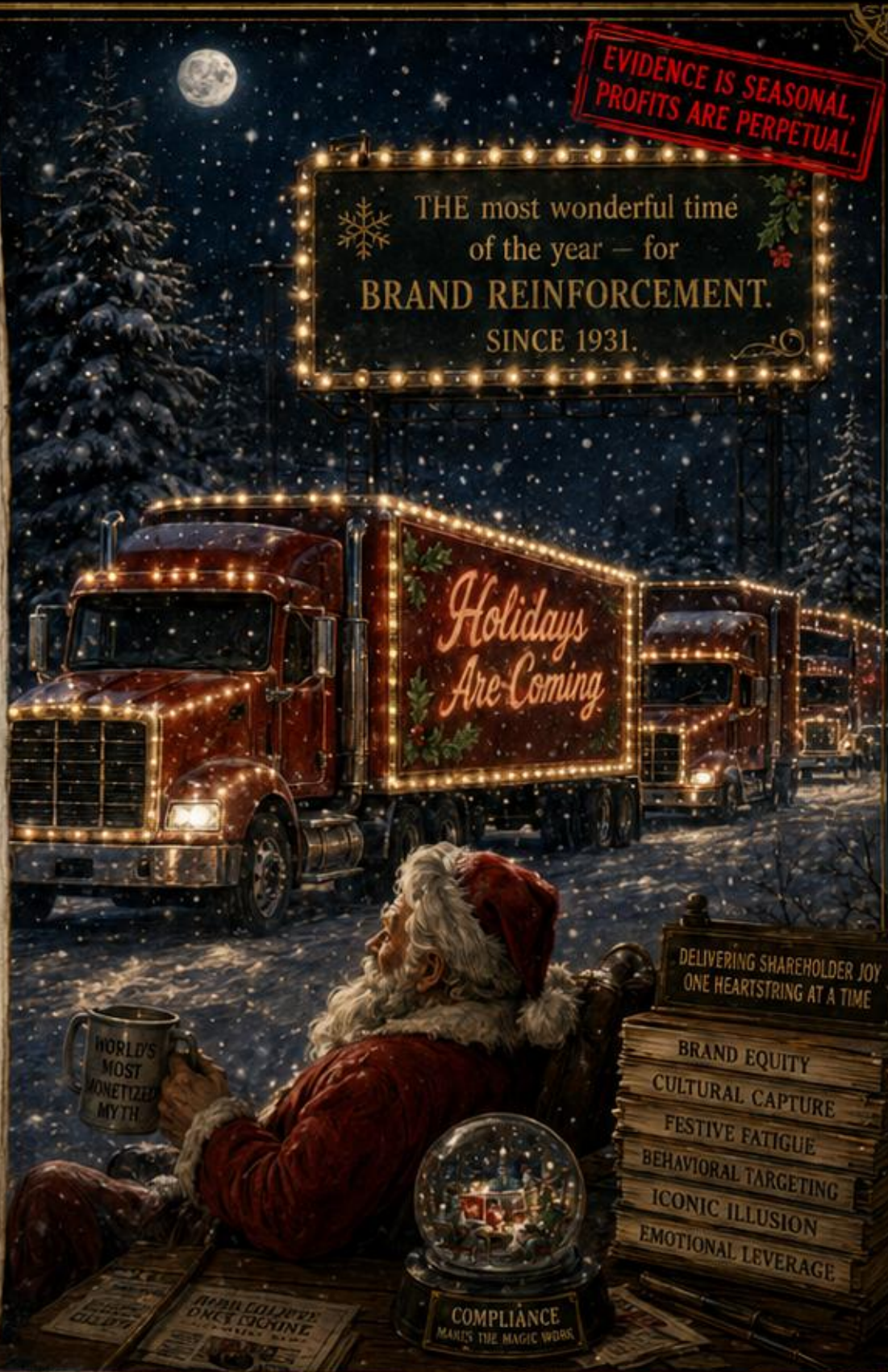
The recursive paradoxes remain unsolved.

And yes, the holidays are definitely coming.

~*Martin Ollett*

Department of Highly Unapproved Methods
Defender of the Indefensible
Institutional Insider/Outsider
Coca-Cola Apologist (Reluctantly)

December 2025



ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

I WOULD LIKE TO THANK:



HADDON SUNDBLOM
for creating the most successful act of
cultural engineering in modern history



COCA-COLA
for proving that with enough advertising
budget, you can literally rewrite folklore



THE "HOLIDAYS ARE COMING" ADVERT
for being genuinely, unironically perfect



EVERYONE ON GITHUB
for tolerating this nonsense alongside
the actual physics



THE CONCEPT OF CHRISTMAS
for surviving capitalism and remaining
emotionally effective anyway

T

his paper is dedicated to everyone who
knows it's all manufactured but
cries at the advert anyway.



**WE ARE ALL THE BLACK KNIGHT NOW.
AND THE HOLIDAYS ARE COMING.**



FESTIVE TRUTH. COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCES.
AN ONGOING INVESTIGATION.



PAGE 9 OF 9